

MIND TREASURE:

INTUITIVE WISDOM & THE DYNAMICS OF MYSTERY & MASTERY AT WORK

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*"The more and more you listen,
The more and more you will hear.
The more you hear,
The more and more deeply you will understand."*

~ Khyentse Rinpoche

ANECDOTES: Let's begin with a selection of anecdotes that offer a glimpse of the territory we will explore in this chapter.

△ During a visionary research process at a leading chemical manufacturing plant a project manager commented, "I don't have much of an imagination, and I'm not very intuitive, but I did smell something in that visionary exercise." This observation triggered a chain of associations and inquiries that lead to identifying a waste gas from a chemical processing plant that when captured turned into a multi-million-dollar new business. Never underestimate the power of sharing a hunch and working it through collective intuition.

△ After learning to recognize and develop various mind skills, an R&D manager in a large financial services firm made the following observation. "I never realized how noisy and out of control my mind was until I began to observe it. Yet with practice, I noticed two interesting things. First, just by watching my mind, sometimes it would grow more quiet, sort of like how a muddy glass of water settles down and becomes clear when you stop stirring it. Second, and most exciting, I've learned to discover the clarity in the midst of confusion, the peace within turbulence, the silence here with the sounds. Though the active mind functions are more noticeable, the functions of the quiet mind are always on and attentive. When ordinary thinking, imagination, and intention subside, the lucid clarity of mindful attention remains. As this awareness grows, I am flooded by intuitive insight and am able to accomplish in hour what months of work could never provide."

△ The following comment is representative of the findings of numerous doctors we know who consciously use intuitive diagnostics. "As a medical doctor, intuition is a vital diagnostic tool. The quieter I get inside, the better I am able to feel or sense my patient's condition from the inside out. Intuitive diagnosis not only suggests the nature of their physical ailments, but the intricacies of the cause, and most optimal course of treatment. With practice, I've learned to distinguish the difference between my thoughts about my patients and direct intuitive comprehension of their actual condition. The feedback from standard medical tests helps to clarify and confirm my intuition. Interestingly, this insight can be gained just by holding a patient in mind, even if they are physically distant from me at the time. This has lead me to reconsider the many of my previously held assumptions and beliefs."

△ An especially intuitive R&D project manager in the computer industry noted, "By nature I'm a very analytical engineer and I take pride in the precision of my work. This work has expanded my understanding of the how information is generated and received. I've learned to hold a question about a design problem in mind with a high degree of coherence, and then like a stone dropped into a deep pool, to release the question and simply listen for the reverberations. Sometimes these come as a felt sense that ripens into an image that lends clues to the answer. At other times, clues or answers may come to mind as a metaphor or even in a dream. At other times insight presents itself as a "clear-knowing" devoid of images or concepts. Through this work I've come to a deeper understanding of the words, "Ask and ye shall receive. Knock, and the door will be opened."

△ A lead researcher in a leading biotechnology firm told us, "My genetics research is often guided by intuitive "gut feelings". Over the years I've learned to listen to these feelings and to ask, "What does this mean?" If I am able to listen deeply enough, then the feeling ripens into an idea or an image that informs and inspires my research. In my profession a single intuitive insight can be worth millions of dollars, years of work, or generations of people who live free from disease or suffering. With so much at stake, can we afford not to learn how to listen deeply to our intuitive intelligence?"

△ "Trouble shooting large systems computer failures can be a stressful and time consuming job. Each day the system is down costs millions of dollars. Developing mindfulness and quiet mind skills has helped me and my crew to more quickly quiet and focus our minds under stress and to sort through possible causes to find rapid solutions." Comment by a manager in the Information Systems Division of a large financial services organization.

VISIONARY RESEARCH

One of the most inspiring examples of intuition in our work was a pioneering two-year research project at Weyerhaeuser. Understanding that research methods could be dramatically accelerated by tapping intuition and developing creative intelligence, Jon Dunnington, the program leader, invited me to coach his team in the personal and team skills necessary to succeed in “visionary research”. The intent of this project was to discover and demonstrate the power and potential of new ways of thinking and knowing that could help R&D teams achieve a higher level of performance and make breakthroughs that would help build a better world. We took to heart Einstein’s statement that, “The world we have made as a result of the level of the thinking we have done thus far creates problems that we cannot solve at the same level at which we have created them... We shall require a substantially new manner of thinking if humankind is to survive.”

For two years, the members of our team met every other week to search for breakthrough ideas to the myriad of special research projects going on within various departments. The results of this process were astounding. We learned that the questions we held in our minds would organize our attention, and that the quality and scope of our individual and shared intention determined the bandwidth of possibilities and applications that were revealed through our inquiry. People on the team were inspired and excited by the consistency of results, and the implications for reliably accessing breakthroughs in creativity and innovation at many settings around the globe.

“Our questions were at times like heartfelt prayers,” one person said. “In the silence of our deep listening together, it was as though each of us had learned to push the pause button on the stories we keep telling ourselves about who we are. In this state of deep shared listening, we’d converge like islands meeting at their common roots deep under the surface of the sea, merging within a larger field of Presence in which we are both one and many.”

Here’s one example of our visionary research process on this project. The session leader working on an aqua-culture project discussed his quandary over the disappointing rate of spawning salmon in rehabilitated streams that had been stocked. No one knew why so few salmon were returning. In search of clues, he invited us to join him on an imaginary journey through the life cycle of a salmon. He painted a vivid picture of our life in the hatchery, the day we were loaded into a truck and set loose in the river. Then as we approached the mouth of the river and encountered salt water for the first time, he set our imagination and intuition loose to explore the many forces that

might shape our lives as salmon and determine if we would return to spawn or not. Surfacing from this long, deep dive, we took time to jot or doodle our impressions and then to discuss insights that had come to mind. Some of us describe the trauma of being loaded and unloaded into the truck that took us from the hatchery to the river. Other had valuable insights regarding moving from fresh water into the salt water of the open ocean. Others offered possible clues about conditions at sea that might affect our life cycle and spawning rates. Together these many pieces formed a picture that offered an inspiring number of valuable and unexpected insights for where to look to improve the conditions necessary for increasing the successful release and return of the salmon. Similar intuitive approaches consistently proved fruitful on many other projects related to forest products, land management, and resource issues over the years that we worked together.

Working in this way, each person's insights offered a clue or elicited an insight from others. Our inquiry would build naturally upon itself like atoms coalescing into a complex thought molecule, ideas cascading from question to intuition to explanation to application in an effortless, superconductive way. It seemed that if we could have harnessed the power unleashed by the joy and wonder in this work, we could have lit up the world. Indeed, this was intuition at work!

The answers to our questions were often surprising and unexpected. As one team member reminded us, quoting the respected Benedictine sage, Brother David Steindl-Rast, "Another name for God is surprise!" At times this notion rang so true that we were left stunned into a deeply reverent shared silence. Often we talked about what it would be like to focus these individual and collective skills toward addressing some of the really big challenges facing humanity. At times we sensed that our research work -- this remarkable experiment in deep, shared intuitive inquiry -- was creating a story that would offer inspiration, courage, and guidance for other R&D teams for decades to come. Though the challenges were great, the Ocean of Wisdom seemed intent on splashing itself into our minds as a deeply intuitive knowing, that in response to our questions would weave its way into our thinking and dreaming, providing business solutions, and personal inspirations, that mere observation or logical analysis could never have yielded.

ASPIRATION & INSPIRATION

"There is no inspiration, without aspiration." Tagor

In our work we are often asked to help leaders and teams develop the personal and interpersonal skills necessary for breakthroughs in creativity, intuition, and

performance. Our success in this work lies largely in the methods we use and, in the frameworks, and mental models that we rely on. In this brief chapter I'll offer some insights from our work and focus on the mental models that we've found most effective in helping people to understand and develop their intuitive intelligence. Central to all of these models are the complementary themes of aspiration and inspiration, creativity and receptivity, active and quiet mind skills, mastery and mystery.

Rabbi Zalman Schachter, once helped us to understand the relationship between the active and receptive dynamics of questioning, prayer, and intuition. He reminded us that our lives are filled with prayers, albeit mostly unconscious ones. When we are hungry, our prayer for food organizes our attention to look for restaurants, or fruit trees, or whiffs of dinner on the wind. When we are lonesome, our prayer for companionship organizes our attention to notice people who have partners and those who are potentially available.

Our questions, conscious or unconscious, spoken or unspoken, individual or collective, are prayers, aspirations, and yearnings that infallibly organize our attention and, in the most subtle ways, make us more intuitively receptive to inspiration in whatever forms it may take. As our understanding of this process deepens, we discover that we live in a responsive universe. If you drop a little stone in the pool it sends out and draws back a little wave. If you drop a big stone in the pool, it sends out and draws back a big wave. The moment there is a yearning in

our hearts or a question in our minds -- consciously or unconsciously -- there are echoes of information intuitively available to us. The answer or clues might be revealed in the patterns of a cloud, in a bird's song, or by what a person three seats away is saying. As we learn to listen more deeply, we discover that the answers to our question are always here, though generally speaking our circuits are usually too jammed to hear them.

An especially intuitive R&D project manager in the computer industry noted, "By nature I'm a very analytical engineer and I take pride in the precision of my work. This work has expanded my understanding of the how information is generated and received. I've learned to hold a question about a design problem in mind with a high degree of coherence, and then like a stone dropped into a deep pool, to release the question and simply listen for the reverberations. Sometimes these come as a felt sense that ripens into an image that lends clues to the answer. At other times, clues or answers may come to mind as a metaphor or even in a dream. Through this work I've come to a deeper understanding of the words, "Ask and ye shall receive. Knock, and the door will be opened."

Moment to moment, the Mystery reveals itself to us, and through the experiences of our lives we intuitively discern the answers to our deepest questions and most heartfelt prayers. As a great Persian poet reminds us,

“When you search for the Beloved, it is the intensity of the longing that does all the work. Look at me and you will see a slave of that intensity.”

THE DUAL PATH OF WISDOM

The Dual Path of Wisdom presented below is a powerful conceptual tool for understanding the interplay of creativity and receptivity necessary for intuitive insight at every level of human affairs. Just as our path through life is woven of the complementary paths of our left and right feet, the Dual Path of Wisdom is comprised of two complementary paths (See Figure 1):

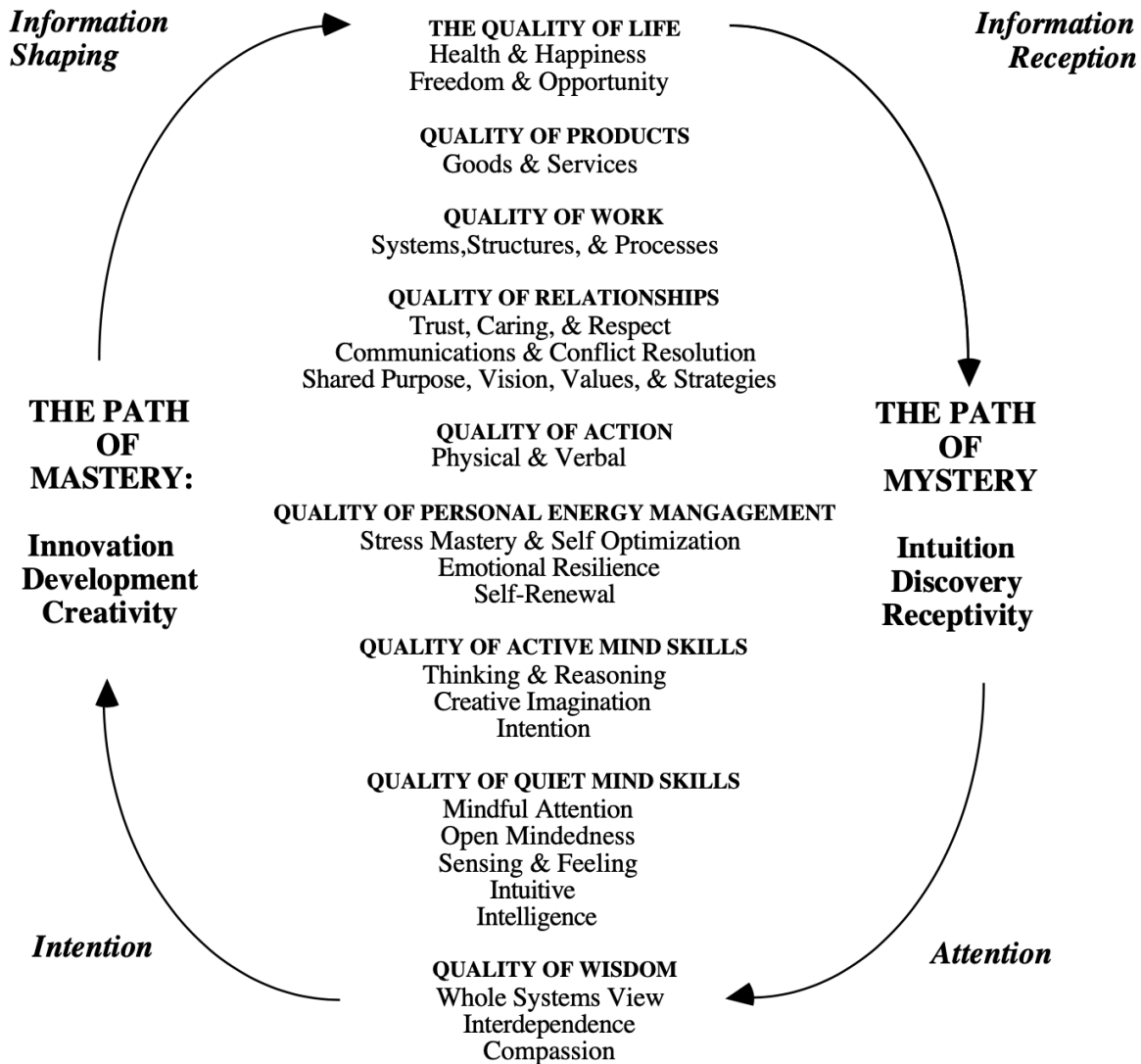
- The Path of Mystery: Insight and Discovery
 - The Path of Mastery: Innovation & Development
- Viewed in detail, the synergy of these paths can be applied to organizational learning by addressing the potentials for insight, intuition, and innovation across nine interrelated domains.

THE NINE DOMAINS OF INTUITION & INNOVATION

Briefly summarized, these nine domains can be viewed as follows:

Every human being has a deep yearning for a high Quality of Life. To realize this we rely on ourselves and others to provide Quality Goods and Services by doing Quality Work. In an increasingly interconnected world, doing quality work requires building and maintaining Quality Working Relationships. These in turn reflect the Quality of our Actions and Communications, the Quality of our Personal Energy Management, the quality of our Active Mind Skills (i.e. thinking, reasoning, intention, imagination) and the quality of our Quiet Mind Skills (i.e. attention, mindfulness, sensing, etc.) and the quality or depth of Wisdom (i.e. intuitive insight, sense of whole systems, and compassion) that we bring to our life and work.

The Dual Path of Wisdom: Integrating The Nine Domains of Intuition at Work



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Figure 1

As you can see, the Quality of Wisdom is the foundation for these nine domains. Our intuitive ability to tap wisdom is determined first by the quality of our Quiet Mind Skills, and then enhanced as intuitive insight incorporates the faculties of each successive level above. To the degree that we have developed any of the fundamental skills or qualities listed in each of the nine domains, our ability to access, develop, and express intuitive insight will be strengthened.

Viewed as a whole system, the complementary Paths of Mystery and Mastery weave the nine domains into cascading interrelationships that are fractilian in nature like a succession of wheels turning within wheels. Understood in this way, we glimpse the profound relationship between our inner and outer worlds and the link between the most subtle and the most fully manifest realities of human existence.

THE PATH OF MASTERY: INNOVATION AND DEVELOPMENT

The "Path of Mastery" gives meaning to information by shaping it into images, ideas, communications and actions. This path spans the nine domains and unfolds along a spectrum ranging from the emergence of the most subtle idea or intention through the progressively more tangible stages of formulation, communication, and action. The primary tools of mastery are action, communication, thinking, imagination, intention and building synergy with the quiet mind skills. The fruit of this path is the joy of accomplishment, a sense of confidence as our wisdom and skill grows, and the affirmation of seeing the fruits of our intuitive insights can be expressed and applied through our work. Following this path inspires us with a sense of mastery, confidence, and control that is complemented by the Path of Mystery's sense of insight, intuition, and discovery.

THE PATH OF MYSTERY: INSIGHT, INTUITION, AND DISCOVERY

The "Path of Mystery" complements the Path of Mastery. Along this path we engage in inquiry, gather information, discover insights, and awaken intuitive wisdom. This path teaches us to live with questions, listen deeply for inspirations, and engage in research or inquiry that ripens as progressively deeper and deeper intuitive insights. Through careful observation and deep receptive listening many subtle and complex patterns of relationship are revealed that might escape superficial observation. The fruits of this path are the wisdom, inspiration, joy of discovery, and sense of wonder, which, as they mature, guide us through the next generation of innovation and development on the Path of Mastery.

WISDOM AND THE SYNERGY OF MASTERY & MYSTERY

Weaving together, the Paths of Mastery and Mystery define the "Dual Path of Wisdom". As our wisdom deepens, the quality of our life improves. Weaving these complementary paths together helps us to continually access, organize, and express a deeper wisdom through our work. The Path of Mystery taps the intuition necessary for continual renewal, inspiration, and innovation through our work. The Path of Mastery assures continuous improvement, adaptation, innovation, integrity, service and

responsiveness to the changing needs of our environment. In this way we participate in the natural cycles of discovery and development, insight and innovation, wisdom and work, that serve as the in-breath and out-breath of the creative process.

CREATIVE INTELLIGENCE

At the very heart of the intuitive process is what we call “creative intelligence”. Creative intelligence is a measure of the integration and synergy we’ve developed between our Active Mind Skills, Quiet Mind Skills, and Wisdom.

Wisdom weaves its way into the world from the inside out. Emerging first as subtle, formless impressions, often gossamer, transparent, so subtle and elusive that they could easily be ignored. If the receptive mindfulness of our Quiet Mind Skills is keen enough, even the most subtle intuitive insight will be noticed, drawn into awareness, and developed through our Active Mind Skills into thoughts, images and impressions that can then be communicated to others.

In order to better understand these different modes of mental function, let's look more closely at the Active and Quiet Mind Skills.

ACTIVE MIND SKILLS

The "Active Mind Skills"(AMS) are the tools of our intellect and reasoning. They include intention or will, thinking, and creative imagination. These skills each play a role in shaping information through the power of *intention*, and give form and meaning to the complexity of our inner experience through the power of thought and imagination. The AMS are vital to organizing and expressing our inner knowing, insights, feelings and intentions through tangible action.

QUIET MIND SKILLS

The "Quiet Mind Skills" (QMS) represent a domain of powerful mental functions that are complementary to and essential for the effective use of the "Active Mind Skills". The QMS are primarily receptive mental functions that gather information through the faculty of mindful attention, sensing, and feeling. These involve the quality of receptivity, "being", or presence, in contrast to the creativity, or “doing” nature of the AMS. Because the mental functions and brain states associated with the QMS are more subtle and less “visible” than the AMS, they are rarely recognized, and seldom fully developed. By way of analogy, the AMS are like the forms and patterns of matter or clouds that we can see or touch, and the active forces of wind, water, or

electromagnetism that shape them. By contrast, the QMS are more “transparent” mental functions that are vast in scope, clear, and open like the sheer presence of the sky.

At work, the QMS determine the coherence and power of all other mental functions. The QMS also provide access to the subtle revelations of intuitive insight so vital to breakthroughs in creativity and innovation. By allowing us to focus our attention more deeply on the work at hand, they enable us to access a deeper, more fundamental wisdom that reveals insight into the nature of our innermost being and the world in which we live. Consciously or unconsciously, all the great scientists and sages of the world have tapped the QMS as the access states necessary to discover the “universal organizing principles” that have inspired and guided the development of humanity throughout the ages. The Quiet Mind Skills also awaken within us a sensitivity to the life-giving forces that we express as universal values, such as wisdom, wonder, creativity and compassion.

THE DUAL NERVOUS SYSTEM: A NEUROLOGICAL BASIS FOR INTUITION

“When I was born in 1895, reality was everything you could see, smell, touch and hear. The world was thought to be absolutely self-evident. When I was three years old, the electron was discovered. That was the first invisible. It didn't get in any of the newspapers; nobody thought that would be important! Today 99.99% of everything that affects our lives cannot be detected by human senses. We live in a world of invisibles. The fact that 99 percent of humanity does not understand nature is the prime reason for humanity's failure to exercise its option to attain universally sustainable physical success on this planet... I am confident that humanity's survival depends on all our willingness to comprehend *feelingly* the way nature works.”
~Buckminster Fuller

Intuition is a biologically primary sense. As inseparable members of a multidimensional whole system, our bodies are sensitive to a multitude of subtle changes in our universe. Our ability to intuitively discern and make sense of these subtle feelings is directly related to our ability to heighten our internal awareness.

The pioneering work of Robert O. Becker, M.D., a leading researcher on the effects of electromagnetic fields on biological systems, has revolutionized our understanding of the nature of the brain-mind and its ability to gather information from its internal and external environment. His discovery of the “dual nervous system” reveals a biological basis for intuition and has been heralded as the single most important discovery in brain sciences in this century, and the most important revolution in biological science!

Brain sciences have focused almost exclusively on only half of the nervous system - the neurons. The neuronal system works on an alternating current (AC) with neurons either "on" as they fire, or "off" when thresholds of stimulation necessary for activation have not been reached. It functions like a digital computer comprised of billions of neurons. The complexity and imaging potential of the 100 billion neurons in your brain - many of which have from 10,000 to 100,000 dendritic connections to other neurons - is virtually unimaginable.

The neurons are surrounded by an exquisite crystalline lattice work of semiconducting sheathes of perineural, or glial (as in "glue") cells, which regulate the formation and the functioning of the neurons. This crystalline lattice is sensitive to minute fluctuations in both internal and external fields and continuously registers subtle variations in voltage power, fluctuations in current strength, and any differential in the flow and current direction. These wave forms carry enormously large amounts of information and each subtle variation in the field fluctuations and potentials conveys meaningful forms or qualities of energy.

The perineural nervous system, sometimes called the deep nervous system, appears to have been the original data-transmission and control system present in the earliest living organisms. The exquisite sensitivity of this system equips organisms with the capacity to register and adapt to the constantly changing influences of its natural environment. The function of this deep neural system can be compared to an analog computer transmission. Analog computers are older than the digital systems and do not operate on signal pulsations per unit of time. Instead, information is coded by the strength of the current and the direction of its flow. This system operates on a direct current (DC) and is always "on", attuning us to subtle fluctuations in environmental electromagnetic fields. Though this system is much slower than the neuronal digital system, it is extremely precise and responsive to the exquisitely subtle frequency variations from our multidimensional environment. These subtle impressions, sensations, feelings are often the substrate of intuitive insight. (See Figure 2).

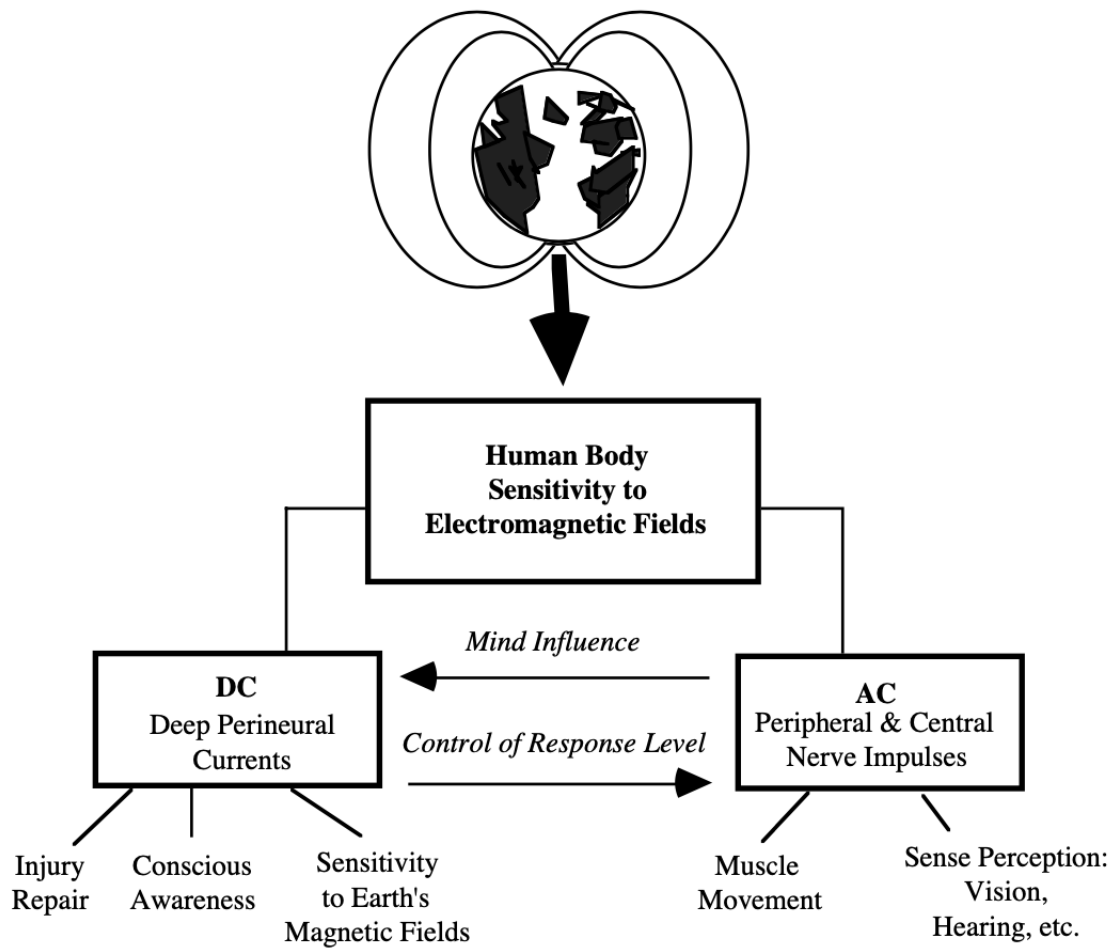


Figure 2

Transmitting information by means of the flow of a semiconducting direct current (DC), the deep nervous system senses injury, controls repair, and regulates the activity of body cells by generating specific DC electrical fields in their vicinity. It is also the primary system in the brain, which nourishes the neurons and controls their formation and functioning. Furthermore, it has been hypothesized as the basis for the morphogenetic field itself. In these ways, the deep nervous system determines thresholds of our neuronal sensitivity, our level of consciousness, our decision-making processes, and the quality of our intuitive insight.

The profound implications of the discovery of the dual nervous system for helping us understand the neurological and biological mechanisms of intuition are just beginning to emerge. These intriguing findings remind us to view ourselves as conscious fields of energy within a boundless energetic environment. They invite us to appreciate and tune into the exquisite sensitivity of our bodies as multidimensional antennae

inseparably embedded within and tuned to our larger body, the universe. Again we are reminded that the Quiet Mind Skills are essential for the subtle sense of intuitive wisdom to be brought into conscious awareness.

THRESHOLDS OF SENSITIVITY AND SENSIBILITY

Another mental model that is helpful to understand mechanisms of intuition is to consider the following analogy from the physical sciences. In terms of scale, we can clearly see objects only as small as $1/10$ cm. With the aid of technology, images can be enlarged up to a 100 million times to reveal a one-to-one correspondence between optical image and objective reality. Yet beyond this threshold, approximately 10^{-16} cm., about the size of an atom, direct imaging or perception of reality becomes impossible. Crossing this threshold, we enter the domain of quantum physics, the realm of the vacuum state, an ocean of energy from which subatomic particles arise and into which they dissolve. Here we revert to thinking about reality in terms of mathematical extrapolation and the logic of physics.

As we approach 10^{-33} cm., the wavelength of Planck's constant, wave forms accelerate to reach the speed of light. Crossing this threshold, the whole fabric of space-time reality as we know it disintegrates, and we encounter incomprehensible mystery, a realm of unimaginable power and potential that lies at the very foundation of each of our beings.

Speaking of the power and potential latent in the Mystery at the deepest ground of our being, the late physicist David Bohm said,

"If you compute the amount of energy that would be in space with that shortest possible wavelength (10^{-33} cm.), then it turns out that the energy in one cubic centimeter would be immensely beyond the total energy of all the known matter in the universe.... The vacuum contains all this energy which is then ignored by physics because it cannot be measured by an instrument... Theoretical physics implies that empty space has all this energy and matter is a slight increase of the energy... like a small ripple on this tremendous ocean of energy, having some relative stability and being manifest. Therefore, my suggestion is that this implicate order implies a reality immensely beyond what we call matter. Matter itself is merely a ripple in this background."

Since we are multidimensional and intuitive beings, we embody all these dimensions. Though our intuitive abilities may be limited, our intuitive potential is unbounded.

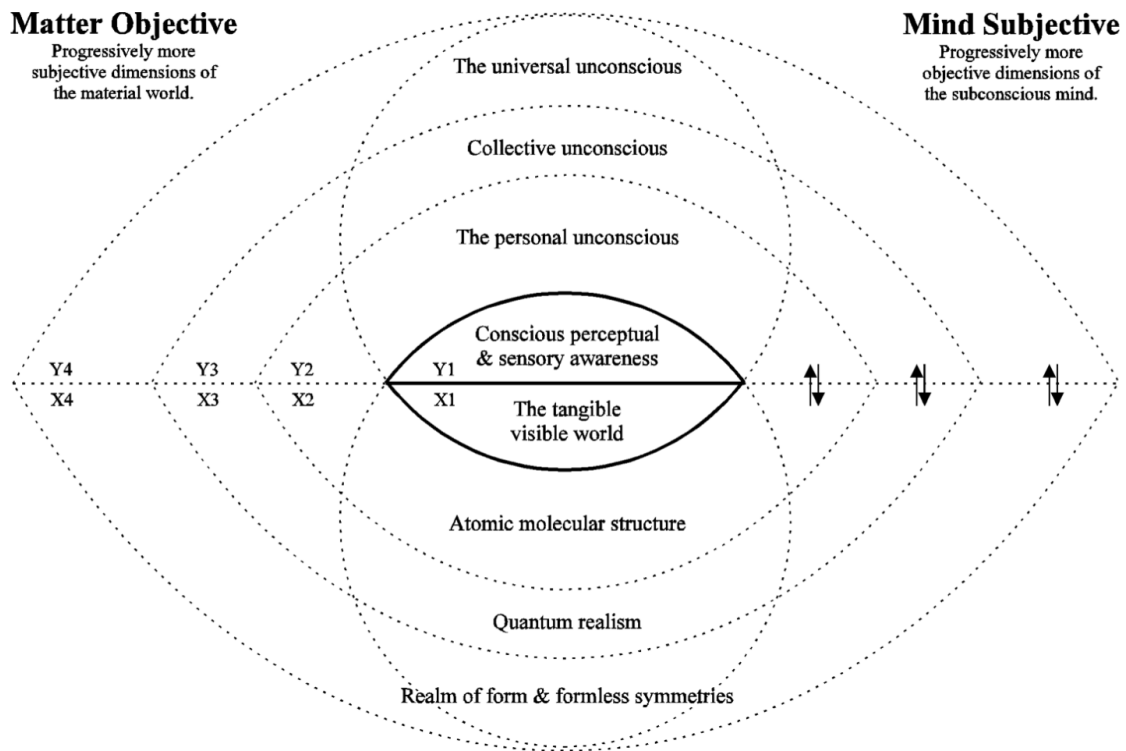
THE MIND-MATTER INTERPHASE:

"The most exciting breakthrough of the 21st Century will occur not because of technology, but because of an expanding concept of what it means to be human."

~John Naisbitt

One of the most useful models I have found for understanding the inseparability of the mental and material aspects of reality in the intuitive process. (See Figure 3). The most central region can be regarded as the meeting ground between our tangible material world (X1) , and our conscious perception and sensory cognitive awareness of that world (Y1). Here, the relative reality of our dualistic separation between subject and object, observer and observed, is indicated by the solid black line separating these two realms.

Expanding out from here, both matter and mind are associated with increasingly subtle dimensions of organization and function. These are represented by the three domains nested around the central meeting ground. The first layer beneath conscious awareness can be regarded as the personal unconscious (Y2). This is the domain of all of our personal psychological patterning in terms of identity, personality, memory, drives, complexes, etc. The contents of this domain are generally unknown and unexpressed by the conscious mind. The corresponding domain in matter, is the atomic realm (X2) that is underlying and causal to the substantial material world. Here, we understand the relationship of substance to its atomic and molecular properties as being similar to the relationship of our personal identity and personality to the complex and formative forces of our personal unconscious. These mutually reflective and inseparable realities are like two sides of the same coin, one the inverse reflection of the other. Just as the modulation or recombination of molecular bonds or properties will initiate material transformation, fundamental changes in the unconsciousness of an individual result in potentially profound transformation in their conscious development.



The Mind-Body Interphase

Figure 4

At the next level we encounter the meeting grounds of quantum reality (X3) and the collective unconscious (Y3). Traditionally physicists, have regarded the atomic structure of matter in a purely objective way, while psychologists have regarded the personal unconscious in a purely subjective manner. In recent decades, a revolution has occurred in both physics and the mind sciences as Heisenberg and other quantum physicists discovered that our subjective mental influences directly affect the organization of subtle levels of matter (X3) and modern psychologists discovered that objective universal principles underlie and are fundamental to individual subjective awareness.

At the next level we arrive at the meeting ground of what physicists describe as "a realm of pure immaterial symmetries and geometrical patterns that guide the interactions and fluctuations of the quantum fields" (X4). This is mirrored in mind by a domain regarded as the "universal unconscious" (Y4), a realm of pure unimaginable potentials and archetypes. In both physics and psychology, these elusive, powerful, pre-formative domains remain a mystery beyond the scope of any capacity for symbolic representation or explanation.

In essence, as psychologists come to deeper understanding of the subjectivity of the mind, they are discovering increasingly objective and dynamic psychic structures. As physicists come to understand the deep nature of matter more objectively, they are encountering increasingly subjective influences. As these two streams of inquiry into the nature of reality progress, the mind-matter interphase reveals that both material and mental phenomena emerge from the same continuum and are internal and external reflections of each other.

DISCOVERING REALITY

As multidimensional beings we are inseparable from our multidimensional universe. Understanding our inseparability from all creation, we realize that intuitive intelligence is as integral to our being as the water of the ocean is to the myriad of tiny waves that rise and fall upon it. We come fully equipped to discern and understand the full spectrum of reality. To develop intuition is to learn to contact reality directly. Consciousness functioning as thought, as opposed to direct intuitive insight, is obscured and cannot realize the nature of reality firsthand. To understand the nature of intuition it is helpful to distinguish between different modes of knowing reality.

One way to understand the nature of reality and how we know it is to think in terms of three levels: body-matter, mind, and spirit-consciousness which correspond to three ways of knowing. (See Figure 4).

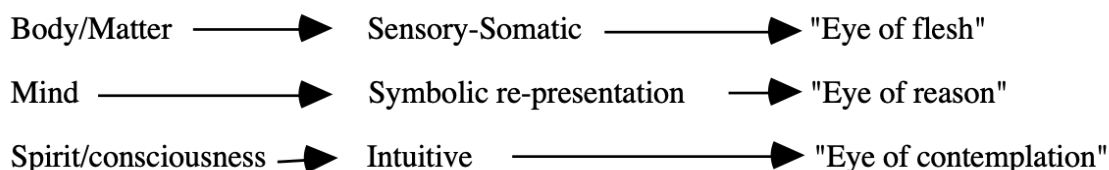


Figure 4

The Christian mystics referred to these as the eye of the flesh, the eye of reason, and the eye of contemplation. Aristotle referred to these realms as *techne*, *praxis* and *theoria*.

To better understand the nature of intuition, let's consider five different modes of knowing, each of which is like a color diffracting from the total spectrum of human experience. (See Figure 5). Let's first consider the three modes of knowing associated with mind as inspired by the work of Ken Wilber.

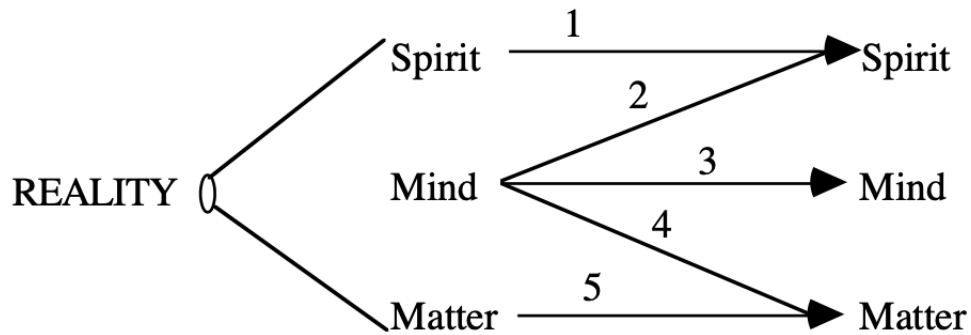


Figure 5

- Mind relating to Spirit- paradoxical mode (2)
- Mind relating to mind - phenomenology mode (3)
- Mind relating to body - empirical mode (4)

Generally speaking, as mind relates to body, mental activity, or spirit, it bifurcates itself into a dualistic subject-object mode and re-presents direct experience to itself symbolically in terms of abstract thought. These thoughts have a reality of their own, as merely symbolic thoughts which are different from the realities that they attempt to represent, i.e. thinking about spirit is indeed paradoxical. For this reason, all the world's great wisdom traditions remind us that the absolute nature of reality cannot be reduced to mere concepts, names or symbols. It must be and can be directly intuited. As the great Chinese philosopher Sengtsan said in his classic work, "The more you talk and think about the truth, the farther astray you wander from it. Stop talking and thinking and there is nothing you will not be able to know!"

Intuition is direct, unmediated knowing. Mode 5 is our direct experience of our universe via the multidimensional antenna of our body. This mode of knowing is direct, continuous, unbroken, non-symbolic, and if we learn to "listen" deeply enough, it is a motherlode of intuition.

Intuition as direct, non-symbolic experience also takes place in mode 1. As multidimensional beings we are endowed with an omnidimensional depth that transcends and defies description or definition in terms of ordinary physics and biology. These dimensions of our reality are described as consciousness if we wear psychological lenses, or as Spirit if we take a more religious or spiritual view. Whatever we call it, our most fundamental deep reality is as mysterious as quantum or transliminal reality is to physicists. At the heart and core of our being, each of us is in

contact with this ground of reality out of which all things come. Here we touch dimensions of ourselves that are non-local, trans-temporal, unbounded, omniscient, incomprehensible, inexpressible, yet intimately real. Though we may be unable to fully express intuitive insights drawn from these levels of reality in linguistic, mathematical, or artistic symbology, even a moment of such direct apprehension may profoundly inspire and guide an entire lifetime or culture.

Cultivating a mindful awareness of the interrelationships of these five ways of knowing develops the keenness of mind necessary to recognize the difference between our thoughts *about* reality and our direct, intuitive wisdom.

FRONTIERS OF INTUITIVE RESEARCH

We live at an exciting and terrifying time when the tools of modern science and technology provide us with more information about our world than we can assimilate. It is said that human knowledge doubles every eighteen months, yet as it does, we seem to feel more out of control and lacking in wisdom.

Foremost among the leading research efforts on intuition and the mind-matter interphase is the Princeton Engineering Anomalies Research (PEAR) on the Scientific Study of Consciousness-Related Physical Phenomena, founded by Robert G. Jahn, Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science, and his colleagues in 1979. Describing the implications and applications of thousands of experiments over sixteen years of research they remind us that:

“Beyond its scientific impact and its technological applications, clear evidence of an active role of consciousness in the establishment of reality holds sweeping implications for our view of ourselves, our relationship to others, and to the cosmos in which we exist. These in turn must inevitably impact our values, our priorities, our sense of responsibility, and our style of life. Integration of these changes across society can lead to a substantially superior cultural ethic, wherein the long-estranged siblings of science and spirit, of analysis and aesthetics, of intellect and intuition, and many other subjective and objective aspects of human experience will be productively reunited.”

There is considerable evidence from decades of rigorous research at Princeton, Stanford, Duke, SRI, Menninger Foundation, and other respected research centers around the globe to suggest that although ordinary sense perception and logic are inoperable beyond certain thresholds, that intuition can plumb and accurately discern the most subtle or distant domains of reality. Thousands of rigorously conducted scientific studies in physics, engineering, psychophysiology, biology, and other fields

have produced “anomalous”, unexplainable results that impel us to expand our definition of reality and the interphase between matter and consciousness. Though considerable effects are being measured, our respected colleagues are dumbfounded and unable to adequately explain their findings within existing scientific paradigms.

What is clear is that under the right circumstances we are, individually and collectively, able to access accurate information intuitively. Though the actual mechanisms are unclear, the personal and group skills necessary to enhance intuition are consistent and lie largely in the realm of the most subtle Quiet Mind Skills and in their synergy with the Active Mind Skills and the skills associated with the domains above them.

A basic outline of strategies for developing personal and team intuition in our work with business includes:

- Learn to recognize and reduce inner and outer conflicts and distress.
- Develop more respectful, caring and trusting relationships with yourself and others.
- Develop the Quiet Mind Skills including the quality of mindful attention and the capacity for sustained “deep listening.”
- Learn to recognize and question assumptions.
- Learn to develop greater focus and coherence of intention and aspiration
- Learn to view self-world-universe more in terms of dynamic, multidimensional and interactive flows and fields of energy-information.
- Develop the Active Mind Skills, communication skills, and quality of working relationships necessary to develop, communicate, and apply intuitive insights through your work.

Intuition is a fundamental and natural mode of knowing that has always played a key role in empirical research and technological development. Modern times offer us a crucible and crisis in which we are being challenged to accelerate our learning and deepen our intuitive wisdom.

“My own working assumption is that we are here as local Universe information gatherers. We are given access to the divine design principles so that from them we can invent the tools that qualify us as problem solvers in support of the integrity of an eternally regenerative Universe.” ~R. Buckminster Fuller

Breath by breath, life passes, death approaches, and we take our world to heart. Holding Mastery in one hand, and the Mystery in the other, we stand rooted in wisdom. Each day the beauty and pain of our world calls out to and through us, asking

us to listen and learn more deeply. Will we listen, love, and learn deeply enough to discover and apply the “divine design principles” necessary to help create a better world? The choice is ours in each mindful moment of our lives.

△△△

BIO- -- THIS NEEDS TO BE UPDATED

Dr. Joel & Michelle Levey are founders of Seattle based InnerWork Technologies, Inc., a firm that specializes in building and renewing organizational cultures in which team spirit, community, creative intelligence, and authentic leadership can thrive. Their pioneering work has inspired leaders and teams in hundres major organizations including: Hewlett-Packard, AT&T Bell Labs, Du Pont, Weyerhaeuser, Travelers Insurance, Petro-Canada, SRI, and NASA. They are on the faculty for International Center for Organization Design, the International Institute for Innovation, and Graduate Faculty at Antioch University. Their intensive “Ultimate Warrior Training Program” for the Green Berets was recognized by US Army West Point logisticians as, “The most exquisite orchestration of human technology we have ever seen.”

Joel and Michelle are co-authors of numerous books including : *Quality of Mind: Tools for Self Mastery & Enhanced Performance*; and Nightingale Conant's best selling business audio program *The Focused Mindstate*. They are contributing authors for numerous works including: *Learning Organizations: Developing Cultures for Tomorrow's Workplace*; *Community Building in Business: Renewing Spirit & Learning*; *Rediscovering the Soul of Business: A Renaissance of Values.*; and *Beyond the Dow: Blending Consciousness & Commerce*.

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Leveys' Chapter for INTUITION AT WORK (San Francisco: Sterling Stone, 1996) Page 24

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Until I began to
Add Renee Weber - Psychics and Saints...